

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA
FAMILY LAW DIVISION

IN RE: THE MARRIAGE OF SARAH
HANSON,

CASE NO. 2024-DR-001150
DIVISION: A

Petitioner/Wife,

and

CHRISTOPER HANSON,

Respondent/Husband.

/

MOTION FOR PROTECTIVE ORDER

Non-Party Witness, Grace M. Samarkos, Esq. by and through undersigned counsel, files this Motion for Protective Order regarding Respondent's Subpoena Duces Tecum for Hearing, and hereby requests a Protective Order preventing Ms. Samarkos' testimony, and as grounds states as follows:

1. On May 19, 2026, Non-Party Witness, Grace M. Samarkos, Esq., was served with a document titled "Subpoena Duces Tecum for Hearing", requiring her to appear before the Honorable Matthew Felix, on May 29, 2026 at 9:00 a.m. at the Hillsborough County Edgecomb Courthouse, 800 E. Twiggs, Street, Courtroom 411, Tampa, FL 33602, to testify on behalf of Respondent/Husband, Christopher Hanson (hereinafter "Mr. Hanson"). The Subpoena also requires Ms. Samarkos to produce certain documents at the hearing, including the "complete client file of Christopher Hanson... notes, drafts, memoranda, billing records and communication." The requested items include several hundreds of pages of documents.

2. Ms. Samarkos' law firm, Harris, Hunt, & Derr, P.A., formerly represented Mr. Hanson in this same litigation. Ms. Samarkos and attorney Katherine Scott were attorneys of record for Mr. Hanson in this proceeding. Harris, Hunt, & Derr, P.A.'s representation of Mr.

Hanson ended on November 8, 2024, when the Court entered an Order approving a Stipulation for Substitution of Counsel with Tampa attorney Vivian Cortes Hodz.

3. Beginning in September 2025, Mr. Hanson has repeatedly threatened to sue Harris, Hunt, & Derr, P.A., on multiple occasions for causes of action including legal malpractice, breach of contract and intentional infliction of emotional distress. Mr. Hanson claims that the actions of the firm while representing him in this Family Court action have caused him “financial and emotional distress.” He further claims lost income, adverse health impacts and an entitlement to punitive damages against the Harris, Hunt, & Derr firm. Mr. Hanson has demanded the payment of a large monetary sum from Harris, Hunt, & Derr, P.A., to avoid the filing of a lawsuit. A copy of Mr. Hanson’s September 26, 2025 demand letter (14+ pages) will be provided to this Court upon request.

4. Ms. Samarkos’ testimony likely to be elicited at the May 29th hearing will concern the same subject matters as would be litigated in the threatened lawsuit by Mr. Hanson. Mr. Hanson attempts to use the hearing to obtain sworn testimony from Ms. Samarkos that he otherwise would not be entitled to, unless he initiated a lawsuit under the Florida Rules of Civil Procedure.

5. Specifically, Mr. Hanson would be required to file a Complaint and serve initial disclosures pursuant to Florida Rule of Civil Procedure 1.280 before any discovery or depositions could be taken in that case. Also, the Complaint would have to survive Motions to Dismiss and/or Motions for Judgment on the Pleadings before Mr. Hanson would be entitled to set depositions of the named defendants.

6. Fla. Fam. L. R.P. 12.280 allows Court to grant Protective Orders upon a showing of good cause to “protect a party or person from annoyance, embarrassment, oppression, or undue burden or expense that justice requires.” Florida courts have broad discretion to manage discovery

and to prevent abusive or prejudicial practices. *See Rojas v. Ryder Truck Rental, Inc.*, 625 So. 2d 106, 107 (Fla. 2d DCA 1993). In this instant case, a Protective Order will shield Mr. Samarkos from unnecessary, premature and burdensome testimony.

WHEREFORE, Non-Party Witness, Grace M. Samarkos, Esq., respectfully requests the Court enter a Protective Order preventing her testimony at the May 29, 2026 hearing, quashing the subpoena served upon her, and grant any further relief deemed just and proper.

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that on this 27 day of May 2026, that the foregoing document is being served this day on all counsel of record and interested parties, via transmission generated by the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal:

Scott Paul Davis, Esq.
HUNTER LAW, P.A.
5025 W. Lemon St., Suite 200
Tampa, FL 33609
(813) 287-2227
scott@hunterlawgroup.com
kathie@hunterlawgroup.com
service@hunterlawgroup.com
Attorney for Petitioner/Wife

Christoper Hanson, Esq.
3934 E. Eden Roc Cir.
Tampa, FL 33634
727-409-5738
truthoverchaos@outlook.com
cahanson77@yahoo.com
Self-represented Respondent

HINSHAW & CULBERTSON, LLP

s/ Burke G. Lopez

Burke G. Lopez
Florida Bar No. 855669
Primary: blopez@hinshawlaw.com
Secondary: jvaldez@hinshawlaw.com,
jrooney@hinshawlaw.com
100 South Ashley Drive
Suite 1310
Tampa, FL 33602
Telephone: 813-276-1662
Facsimile: 813-436-8738
Attorneys for Defendants